JUNIOR SCHOOL LEARNING HUB

GRADE 9 ENGLISH
END-OF-TERM 2 EXAMINATION

Name: _____	Adm. No.: _____	Date: _____	Class: _____
Time: 2 hours 30 minutes	Total: 100 marks	Term: 2	Learning Area: English

INSTRUCTIONS TO LEARNERS

- Answer all questions.
- Read the comprehension passage carefully before answering the questions.
- Observe correct grammar, spelling, punctuation and paragraphing.
- Write neatly and express your ideas clearly.

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (20 MARKS)

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

THE COMMUNITY LIBRARY

For many years, the learners of Mwangaza Junior School had limited access to books outside their classrooms. The school library was small, and most families could not afford to buy extra reading materials. As a result, some learners found it difficult to practise reading regularly.

One Saturday, the learners, teachers and parents met to discuss the problem. They agreed to establish a community library in an unused room near the school. Each family was invited to donate at least one suitable book. Local traders contributed shelves, chairs and reading tables, while a youth group volunteered to paint and clean the room.

The project required careful planning. A committee was formed to register donated books, arrange them by subject and prepare a timetable for library users. The committee also agreed that learners should handle books carefully and return them on time. Within two months, the room had been transformed into a welcoming reading space.

The library soon became popular. Learners visited after school to read stories, research assignments and work together. Parents also borrowed books on farming, health and small businesses. Teachers noticed that many learners were becoming more confident when reading aloud and explaining ideas.

The community library did more than provide books. It brought people together and taught them that shared responsibility can solve local problems. The committee now plans to organise storytelling sessions and invite experienced community members to speak to learners.

1. Why did some learners find it difficult to practise reading regularly? (2 marks)

2. Identify two groups that contributed materials or services to the library project. (2 marks)

3. State two duties assigned to the library committee. (2 marks)

4. Give two ways in which learners used the library. (2 marks)

5. Mention two subjects on which parents could borrow books. (2 marks)

6. What evidence shows that the library benefited learners academically? (2 marks)

7. Explain the meaning of the word 'donate' as used in the passage. (2 marks)

8. Give a suitable alternative title for the passage. (2 marks)

9. What lesson can communities learn from the project? (2 marks)

10. In your own words, explain how the library strengthened the community. (2 marks)

SECTION B: GRAMMAR AND LANGUAGE USE (20 MARKS)

11. Rewrite the sentence in the passive voice: 'The committee arranged the books.' (2 marks)

12. Change into reported speech: Amina said, 'I am preparing for the examination.' (2 marks)

13. Choose the correct word: Neither the teacher nor the learners (was/were) late. (2 marks)

14. Identify the adverb in: 'The visitors spoke politely to the librarian.' (2 marks)

15. Use the word 'although' to combine: 'It was raining. The learners attended the meeting.' (2 marks)

16. Give the plural forms of: (a) criterion (b) shelf. (2 marks)

17. Punctuate correctly: mary asked can we borrow these books today (2 marks)

18. Give a synonym for each word: (a) assist (b) accurate. (2 marks)

19. Identify the subordinate clause in: 'The learners stayed inside because the rain was heavy.' (2 marks)

20. Complete using the correct form of the verb in brackets: By the time we arrived, the lesson _____ (begin). (2 marks)

SECTION C: SUMMARY AND FUNCTIONAL WRITING (20 MARKS)

21. Read the passage in Section A again. In about 50–60 words, summarise the steps the community took to establish the library. (10 marks)

22. Write a formal letter to the headteacher proposing three activities that can encourage learners to read more widely. Include an appropriate address, date, salutation, subject, well-organised paragraphs and a suitable closing. (10 marks)

SECTION D: CREATIVE WRITING (40 MARKS)

23. Write a composition of 350–450 words on ONE of the following topics:
(a) Write a story ending with: 'From that day, I understood the importance of keeping a promise.'
(b) Describe a community activity that can make your neighbourhood a better place to live.
(c) Write a narrative about a time when teamwork helped you overcome a difficult challenge.
(40 marks)

MARKING SCHEME

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Total: 100 marks | Section A: 20 | Section B: 20 | Section C: 20 | Section D: 40

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (20 MARKS)

1. The school library was small and many families could not afford extra reading materials. (2)

2. Any two: families/parents, local traders, youth group, learners/teachers. (1 each)

3. Any two: register donated books; arrange books by subject; prepare a user timetable; promote careful handling and timely returns. (1 each)

4. Any two: read stories; research assignments; work together/study collaboratively. (1 each)

5. Farming, health or small businesses. Any two. (1 each)

6. Learners became more confident reading aloud and explaining ideas. (2)

7. To give or contribute something freely for a purpose. (2)

8. Any relevant title, e.g. 'A Library for Everyone' or 'Working Together to Build a Library'. (2)

9. Shared responsibility/cooperation can help solve community problems. (2)

10. It brought learners, parents, teachers and local groups together to contribute and use a shared resource. (2)

SECTION B: GRAMMAR AND LANGUAGE USE (20 MARKS)

11. The books were arranged by the committee. (2)

12. Amina said that she was preparing for the examination. (2)

13. were (2)

14. politely (2)

15. Although it was raining, the learners attended the meeting. (2) (Accept equivalent correct construction.)

16. (a) criteria (b) shelves. (1 each)

17. Mary asked, 'Can we borrow these books today?' (2)

18. (a) help/support (b) correct/precise. (1 each; accept suitable synonyms)

19. because the rain was heavy. (2)

20. had begun. (2)

SECTION C: SUMMARY AND FUNCTIONAL WRITING (20 MARKS)

21. Suggested summary points: community meeting identified the need; agreement to use an unused room; families donated books; traders provided furniture; youth group cleaned and painted; committee registered and organised books and prepared a timetable. Award up to 6 marks for relevant content, 2 for organisation/coherence and 2 for language, within the required length. Do not award more than 10. (10)

22. Award marks as follows: sender's address and date (2); recipient/address and salutation (1); clear subject and purpose (1); three relevant reading activities with explanation (3); logical paragraphing and coherence (1); appropriate formal language, grammar and punctuation (1); correct closing and name/signature line (1). Accept other suitable activities such as reading clubs, book fairs, paired reading, author visits and reading challenges. (10)

SECTION D: CREATIVE WRITING (40 MARKS)

Use the following guide for any one topic: Content and relevance (10); organisation, plot/development and paragraphing (10); vocabulary and expression (8); grammar and sentence construction (6); spelling and punctuation (4); creativity and fulfilment of task (2). Total: 40. Accept varied, original responses. Penalise heavily copied or irrelevant work according to school policy.

ADMINISTRATION NOTE

This is an original teacher-prepared assessment resource for practice and school-based assessment. Before administration, the English teacher should verify that the language skills and writing tasks match the actual Grade 9 Term 2 teaching sequence. Accept other correct and well-expressed responses where appropriate.

Prepared by: Junior School Learning Hub